EXEC-04 | Therapist only - all age groups

Emotion and avoidance before a task

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Identify what happens before postponing a task and distinguish emotion, uncertainty, overload and lack of resources. Choose a response to the barrier and a possible first step without attributing difficulty to laziness.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not demand action despite acute distress, pain or exhaustion. Do not use this sheet for exposure, trauma treatment or diagnosis. An unsafe or unsuitable task requires changing the demand, not more effort.

Reusing existing material

EXEC-01 covers starting conditions, and REG-02 identifies emotions and needs. Here connect a specific pre-task barrier with a suitable response; refer to existing sheets without duplicating them.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Dana postpones a registration form because one section is unclear. Instead of forcing completion, she marks the section and asks for an explanation before choosing another step.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What happens just before I put off the task?

2 | Question for discussion

What emotion, thought or need do I recognize?

3 | Question for discussion

What practical conditions make starting difficult?

4 | Question for discussion

What needs clarification, rest or a request for support?

5 | Question for discussion

What starting step is reasonable after exploring this?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If the person simply says they lack energy, do not try to uncover a hidden emotion. Check needs for rest or reduced workload. If discussion itself is burdensome, stop and arrange another form of support.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Ask simply about feelings and what is missing. Adults should not assume postponement is deliberate refusal; use a drawing or small example to explore.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Make room for fear of judgment and pressures across settings. Agree help that respects choice and privacy rather than continuous performance checking.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Check whether demands are reasonable for resources and roles. Do not turn organizational, financial or accessibility barriers into personal failings.

OA | Older adults

Validate choosing to postpone an unnecessary task. A sudden or concerning change in functioning warrants appropriate assessment, not an explanation based only on age or procrastination.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose a relatively manageable situation and an option to stop. Practice identifying a barrier and choosing, not overcoming emotion or finishing at any cost.

At the next session

Check whether the response fitted the barrier, not only whether the task was done. Learning about unclear requirements or needing help is useful even without completion.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng87/chapter/recommendations
www.nhsinform.scot/illnesses-and-conditions/adhd/managing-adhd-symptoms-in-work-and-education

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